Complete Rules Catalogue

Consultant reference • Exported October 1, 2026

38 rules · 25 implemented and enabled · 13 marked Not Built

This document preserves every rule’s name, code, status, severity, displayed thresholds and remediation from the current Rules-view model. Additional stored policy fields are included in full to support defining unfinished checks. Source wording is preserved, including historical validation claims and caveats; it has not been rewritten into new requirements.

> **Status interpretation:** Not Built takes precedence over the stored enabled flag. Twelve unimplemented rules retain enabled=true in their saved definitions; that does not mean they perform a working check. CHOKE_SAFE_FOR_DETAIL is the thirteenth Not Built rule and is disabled pending recalibration. “Enabled” does not guarantee that every file supplies enough evidence for a verdict. This is a rule catalogue, not the file-specific results from a particular inspection.

Saved definitions: current production database, version 1; snapshot created 2026-10-01T04:42:51.944109+00:00.
Snapshot SHA-256: 2008d79feed2bb496aeaed890ab9ec6ba5e0ff8efc363232e8ec48a05c66ddf3.
Implementation labels and threshold visibility: current workspace Rules-view/backend source. Deployed detector code was not independently inspected. Enabled/Disabled corresponds to the current admin view; read-only views may show Locked On/Locked Off.

Rule index

#	Rule	Status	Severity
1	File is PDF-compatible FILE_PDF_COMPATIBLE	Enabled	fail
2	Standard layers present EXPECTED_LAYERS_PRESENT	Enabled	info
3	Artboard contains artwork ART_PRESENT	Enabled	fail
4	Swatch names follow head-mesh-ink SWATCH_NAME_STRUCTURE	Enabled	fail
5	Registration swatch present REGISTRATION_SWATCH_PRESENT	Enabled	flag
6	No duplicate head positions HEAD_NUMBERS_UNIQUE	Enabled	fail
7	Underbase on a coarser mesh UNDERBASE_MESH_COARSER	Enabled	flag
8	Underbase identified by name, colour corroborates UNDERBASE_ROLE_AGREES	Not Built	flag
9	Trap total, where a trap is present UNDERBASE_CHOKE_PER_OBJECT	Enabled	info
10	Mixed trap techniques sum correctly TRAP_TECHNIQUE_CONSISTENT	Enabled	info
11	Choke does not erase fine base detail CHOKE_SAFE_FOR_DETAIL	Not Built	flag
12	Underbase artwork aligns with the colour artwork ARTWORK_IN_REGISTER	Enabled	fail
13	Fill and stroke on one object use the same ink FILL_STROKE_SAME_COLORANT	Not Built	flag
14	Based colour abutting negative space must be trapped TRAP_AT_NEGATIVE_SPACE	Enabled	fail
15	No choke where white prints on base UNDERBASE_NO_CHOKE_UNDER_WHITE	Enabled	flag
16	Inks overlap only in a trap band INK_OVERLAP_NOT_TRAP	Not Built	flag

#	Rule	Status	Severity
17	Swatch label block matches the artwork SWATCH_LABEL_MANIFEST	Not Built	flag
18	Ink change noted for production INK_CHANGE_DECLARED	Not Built	info
19	Stray sub-spec strokes look like trim residue TRIM_ARTIFACT_RESIDUE	Enabled	flag
20	Gradient blend technique present GRADIENT_BLEND_ACROSS_ARTBOARDS	Enabled	flag
21	Base exists under every colour that needs one UNDERBASE_COVERAGE	Enabled	fail
22	Underbase present on dark garments UNDERBASE_REQUIRED_DARK	Not Built	fail
23	No underbase on light garments UNDERBASE_ABSENT_LIGHT	Not Built	flag
24	Every art object uses a spot separation SEPARATION_ONLY_ART	Enabled	fail
25	No stray CMYK plates NO_PROCESS_PLATES	Enabled	flag
26	Every declared separation carries artwork NO_EMPTY_PLATES	Enabled	fail
27	All artwork text outlined ART_TEXT_OUTLINED	Enabled	fail
28	Marks layer text is expected MARKS_TEXT_EXPECTED	Enabled	info
29	Placed images at least 300 dpi IMAGE_MIN_DPI	Not Built	flag
30	Placed images above hard floor IMAGE_HARD_MIN_DPI	Not Built	fail
31	Placed images not RGB IMAGE_NOT_RGB	Not Built	fail
32	No zero-width strokes NO_HAIRLINE_STROKES	Enabled	fail
33	Minimum stroke weight STROKE_MIN_WIDTH	Enabled	flag
34	Plate count matches ordered colours PLATE_COUNT_MATCHES_ORDER	Not Built	fail
35	Artboards share trim size and origin ARTBOARDS_REGISTERED	Enabled	fail
36	Print size within location preset PRINT_SIZE_VS_LOCATION	Not Built	fail
37	Opacity below 100% present OPACITY_VARIATION_PRESENT	Enabled	flag
38	Mesh tally for the screen department MESH_TALLY	Enabled	info

RULE 1 OF 38 · ENABLED

File is PDF-compatible

FILE_PDF_COMPATIBLE

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	This file was not saved with PDF compatibility. Ask seps.io to resave from Illustrator with 'Create PDF Compatible File' checked.

Full stored rule details

Description	Parses as PDF. Confirmed on all 4 samples.
Check type	boolean_presence
Layer scope	*

Target / measurement definition	{
	  "object": "doc",
	  "field": "parses_as_pdf"
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	  "value": true
	}

Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	4/4 pass
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	10
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 2 OF 38 · ENABLED

Standard layers present

EXPECTED_LAYERS_PRESENT

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	info
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	Layer structure differs from the common template. Not a defect.

Full stored rule details

Description	Reports the layer structure. Layer names and which layer holds the art both vary legitimately across files and eras (2021-23 files have no Koozie Guides layer; recent files put art on either PASTE ART HERE or Reg Marks & Info). Informational only.
Check type	enum_match
Layer scope	*
Target / measurement definition	`{ "object": "layers" }`
Expected values / rule definition	`{ "contains": [ "PASTE ART HERE", "Reg Marks & Info" ] }`
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	4/4 pass
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	20
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 3 OF 38 · ENABLED

Artboard contains artwork

ART_PRESENT

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	This artboard has no artwork on it at all. Send back to seps.io.

Full stored rule details

Description	Each artboard must carry actual separation geometry. Which LAYER it sits on is not a defect - artists paste art onto whichever layer is active, and a finished output file is judged on having art, a filename and swatch names, not on layer hygiene.
Check type	numeric_range
Layer scope	*
Target / measurement definition	<pre>{ "object": "objects", "field": "count", "scope": "any_layer" }</pre>
Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "min": 1 }</pre>
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	31/31 artboards across the 2025-26 corpus carry art. 8/16 of the #22541-#22600 batch carry it on Reg Marks & Info rather than PASTE ART HERE - confirmed by Tyler as normal, not a fault
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	30
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 4 OF 38 · ENABLED

Swatch names follow head-mesh-ink

SWATCH_NAME_STRUCTURE

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	A swatch name does not follow our head-mesh-ink convention. Ask seps.io to rename - our press setup and plate ordering both key off this structure.

Full stored rule details

Description	Names match {head}-{mesh}-{ink}. Compound forms are legitimate and carry meaning: TWO head groups with ONE ink = same art burned on two screens (double-hit white, or varying mesh). TWO head groups with TWO inks = one film used for two garment colourways. ONE head group with TWO inks = an INK CHANGE mid-production: the press is stopped, one ink cleaned out and the other loaded. All three are valid - do not fail any of them.
Check type	regex_match
Layer scope	*

Target / measurement definition	{
	  "object": "colorants",
	  "exclude": [
	  "All"
	  ]
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	  "pattern": "^\\d+(-\\d+)?(\\s*&\\s*\\d+(-\\d+)?)?-.+$"
	}

Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	11/11 real names pass. 22699 "5-200-Grey 429 & Yellow 121" is an ink change, NOT an error - an earlier draft wrongly failed it. 22591 "1-160&10-160-White&Navy 289" has no spaces around the ampersand and was rejected by the earlier pattern - both spellings are legitimate
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	40
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 5 OF 38 · ENABLED

Registration swatch present

REGISTRATION_SWATCH_PRESENT

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	No registration swatch found. Confirm the file was run through Pre-Press Pro - without registration marks the press cannot align the plates.

Full stored rule details

Description	The 'All' swatch (DeviceCMYK 1,1,1,1) carries registration marks.
Check type	boolean_presence
Layer scope	*

Target / measurement definition	{
	  "object": "colorants",
	  "filter": {
	  "name": "All"
	  }
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	  "value": true
	}

Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	4/4 present
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	50
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 6 OF 38 · ENABLED

No duplicate head positions

HEAD_NUMBERS_UNIQUE

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	Two separations are assigned to the same head position. Ask seps.io to renumber - as delivered this cannot be set up on press.

Full stored rule details

Description	Two separations assigned to the same head is a press setup conflict.
Check type	count_match
Layer scope	*
Target / measurement definition	<pre>{ "object": "colorants", "field": "head", "exclude": ["All"] }</pre>
Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "unique": true }</pre>
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	4/4 pass
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	60
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 7 OF 38 · ENABLED

Underbase on a coarser mesh

UNDERBASE_MESH_COARSER

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	The underbase is specified on a finer mesh than we normally run. Confirm with the artist - the base usually runs 160 to lay down enough ink.

Full stored rule details

Description	Underbase runs 160; colours run 200-230.
Check type	numeric_range
Layer scope	*

Target / measurement definition	{
	  "object": "colorants",
	  "filter": {
	  "role": "underbase"
	  },
	  "field": "mesh"
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	  "max": 180
	}

Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	true
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	2/2 underbase files = 160 mesh
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	70
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 8 OF 38 · NOT BUILT

Underbase identified by name, colour corroborates

UNDERBASE_ROLE_AGREES

Rules view fields

Status	Not Built
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	A swatch named as the underbase does not display in Rhodamine Red, or the roles are otherwise unclear. Ask seps.io to confirm which separation is the base before this goes to the floor - note that Rhodamine Red is also a legitimate ink, so the name is what decides.

Full stored rule details

Description	Name is authoritative: the underbase is the swatch whose ink segment is "Under". Rhodamine Red (229,6,149) is the display proxy but is ALSO a real ink - see 6-230-Rhodamine Red C in 91825 - so display colour alone must never assign the underbase role.
Check type	enum_match
Layer scope	*

Target / measurement definition	<pre>{
	  "object": "colorants",
	  "filter": {
	  "role": "underbase"
	  }
	}</pre>

Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "name_ink_segment": "Under", "corroborating_rgb": [229, 6, 149], "precedence": "name_wins" }</pre>
Tolerance	<pre>{ "rgb_abs": 4 }</pre>
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	2/2 agree; 91825 proves colour alone gives a false positive
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	80
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 9 OF 38 · ENABLED

Trap total, where a trap is present

UNDERBASE_CHOKE_PER_OBJECT

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	info
Thresholds shown in view	`choke_plus_spread_pt: 0.75` `abs: 0.02`
Remediation	A trapped shape does not sum to 0.75pt. Choke and spread may be split any way that totals 0.75 - ask seps.io for the missing amount, not for a particular technique.

Full stored rule details

Description	Reports the trap sum where trapping exists. The invariant when trapped is choke_pt + spread_pt = 0.75 per shape pair (0.375 pt net), however split: A all choke, B all spread, C any split. This rule does NOT require a trap to exist - absence of trap is frequently correct (see TRAP_AT_NEGATIVE_SPACE). It only reports whether the trapping that IS present sums correctly.
Check type	numeric_range
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE
Target / measurement definition	`{ "object": "choke_pairs", "field": "stroke_pt" }`
Expected values / rule definition	`{ "choke_plus_spread_pt": 0.75, "net_trap_pt": 0.375, "techniques": { "A_choke_only": [ 0.75, 0 ], "B_spread_only": [ 0, 0.75 ], "C_split": "any pair summing to 0.75" } }`
Tolerance	`{ "abs": 0.02, "unit": "pt" }`
Applies when	{}
Requires context	true
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	A: 11/11 (22499), 7/7 (22880). B: 161/161 (91825). C: 8/8 (21825) at 0.25 spread + 0.50 choke = 0.75, bbox delta 0.0pt after removing the planted 1pt offset
Illustrator action	`{ "op": "stroke", "width": 0.75, "align": "center", "color": "none", "target": "underbase_copy" }`
Sort order	90
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 10 OF 38 · ENABLED

Mixed trap techniques sum correctly

TRAP_TECHNIQUE_CONSISTENT

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	info
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	This file mixes choke and spread. That is allowed when each shape totals 0.75pt - check the trap total rather than the technique.

Full stored rule details

Description	SUPERSEDED as a defect check. Mixing choke and spread within one file - and within one shape - is legitimate; what matters is that each shape totals 0.75pt. Retained only to surface the mix so a reviewer knows what they are looking at.
Check type	enum_match
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE
Target / measurement definition	<pre>{ "object": "trap_pairs", "field": "technique" }</pre>
Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "per_shape_total_pt": 0.75 }</pre>
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	true
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	21825 mixes all three techniques and every shape that totals 0.75 is correct
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	95
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 11 OF 38 · NOT BUILT

Choke does not erase fine base detail

CHOKE_SAFE_FOR_DETAIL

Rules view fields

Status	Not Built
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	This artwork has base detail too fine to choke - shapes fragment or disappear at 0.375pt. Ask seps.io to spread the colour instead of choking the base. If the base is choked away under small detail, the colour prints directly on the garment there and will look duller than the same ink elsewhere in the print.

> Implementation note: detector code exists, but this rule is deliberately excluded from the implemented list and locked disabled pending recalibration. The view labels it Not Built.

Full stored rule details

Description	Simulate a 0.375pt erosion of the underbase geometry. If shapes fragment or vanish, a choke destroys base under fine detail - the top colour then prints straight onto the garment there and reads duller than the same ink elsewhere. Spread-on-colour must be used instead.
Check type	numeric_range
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE

Target / measurement definition	{
	  "object": "underbase",
	  "op": "erode",
	  "amount_pt": 0.375,
	  "measure": [
	  "component_count_delta",
	  "vanished_components"
	  ],
	  "noise_floor_sqpt": 0.1
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	  "fragments": 0,
	  "vanished": 0
	}

Tolerance	{}

Applies when	{
	  "trap_technique": "choke_base"
	}

Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	DISABLED pending recalibration. The erosion-topology prediction matched seps.io's technique choice on 3/3 files during phase 0, but the rebuilt detector reports 2 vanishing shapes on 22499 - a file Tyler confirmed good and correctly choked. The metric is sensitive to render dpi, kernel shape and whether it runs on authored or composited geometry; it is not shipping until those are pinned down.

Illustrator action	{
	  "op": "prefer_technique",
	  "value": "spread_colour"
	}

Sort order	96
Stored enabled value	false

RULE 12 OF 38 · ENABLED

Underbase artwork aligns with the colour artwork

ARTWORK_IN_REGISTER

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	`abs: 0.02`
Remediation	The underbase artwork is shifted relative to the colour artwork - the plates will not register on press. The registration marks still line up, so this will not be caught by eye at the press. Ask seps.io to realign the artboards and resend.

Full stored rule details

Description	Match art-layer shapes across artboards by size, then take the median translation between them. A uniform non-zero offset means one artboard has been nudged - the plates will not register on press even though the artboards and registration marks line up perfectly.
Check type	dimension_match
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE

Target / measurement definition	{
	  "object": "art_shapes",
	  "op": "median_translation",
	  "across": "artboards",
	  "match_by": "shape_size",
	  "report": [
	  "dx",
	  "dy",
	  "offset_pt",
	  "spread"
	  ]
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	  "offset_pt": 0
	}

Tolerance	{
	  "abs": 0.02,
	  "unit": "pt"
	}

Applies when	{
	  "artboards_gt": 1
	}

Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	planted-error test: 21825 nudged one artboard by a single arrow click -> detected exactly 1.000pt dx across 126/126 shapes. 22499 0.000 (48/48), 22880 0.000 (54/54), 91825 0.000 (355/365)
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	97
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 13 OF 38 · NOT BUILT

Fill and stroke on one object use the same ink

FILL_STROKE_SAME_COLORANT

Rules view fields

Status	Not Built
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	An object is filled in one ink and stroked in another. Confirm this is intended - the underbase is built from the fill, so the stroke ink will extend past the base with no trap. Also check the stroke weight.

Full stored rule details

Description	A path filled in one separation and stroked in another is unusual at Mint and changes how the object interacts with the underbase - the base is built from the fill, so a stroke in a different ink extends past it untrapped.
Check type	enum_match
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE

Target / measurement definition	{
	"object": "paths",
	"compare": [
	"fill_colorant",
	"stroke_colorant"
	],
	"same_geometry": true
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	"equal": true
	}

Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	caught 22563 planted defect: 2 paths filled 5-230-Blue 286 C, stroked 6-230-Gray 432 at 0.1pt
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	98
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 14 OF 38 · ENABLED

Based colour abutting negative space must be trapped

TRAP_AT_NEGATIVE_SPACE

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	`trap_required_below_pct: 70` `trap_not_required_above_pct: 85`
Remediation	A colour on the underbase meets bare garment at its edge with no trap. Ask seps.io for the standard 0.75pt trap. Shapes fully enclosed by a knocked-out colour do not need one - a minimal choke there is optional habit, not a requirement.

Full stored rule details

Description	A based colour needs a trap only where its perimeter meets negative space (bare garment). Where the colour is bounded by another ink - typically a white or a colour that is itself knocked out of the underbase - it sits snugly inside that ink and needs no choke. Measured as the fraction of each colorant's perimeter adjacent to another ink. White is exempt: it is the bounding ink and needs no choke over base.
Check type	numeric_range
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE
Target / measurement definition	`{ "object": "colorants", "field": "perimeter_abutting_other_ink_pct", "exclude_inks": [ "white" ], "raster_dpi": 200 }`
Expected values / rule definition	`{ "trap_required_below_pct": 70, "trap_optional_between_pct": [ 70, 85 ], "trap_not_required_above_pct": 85 }`
Tolerance	`{ "note": "three-state: below 70 untrapped = fail, 70-85 untrapped = flag, above 85 = pass" }`
Applies when	`{ "has_underbase": true }`
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	13 colorant measurements at 200dpi. Untrapped files (22583 B/F, 22563 F, 22560 B/RS) non-white inks: 76.2-93.4% abutting. Trapped files (22599 B, 22596 B, 22586 F): 0.0-56.0%. Clean separation, no overlap. Also caught the 21797 planted defect
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	99
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 15 OF 38 · ENABLED

No choke where white prints on base

UNDERBASE_NO_CHOKE_UNDER_WHITE

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	A choke has been applied to base beneath white ink. White on white needs no choke - confirm with seps.io, though this is cosmetic rather than a press problem.

Full stored rule details

Description	Underbase beneath white takes no stroke.
Check type	boolean_presence
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE

Target / measurement definition	{
	  "object": "choke_pairs",
	  "filter": {
	  "top_ink_role": "white"
	  },
	  "field": "has_stroke"
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	  "value": false
	}

Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	true
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	47 white fills -> 0 (22880); 43 white fills -> 0 strokes (91825)
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	100
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 16 OF 38 · NOT BUILT

Inks overlap only in a trap band

INK_OVERLAP_NOT_TRAP

Rules view fields

Status	Not Built
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	Two inks overlap by more than a trap band - one colour appears to be sitting underneath another. Check registration and layering against the approved proof before this goes to the floor.

Full stored rule details

Description	NEEDS TUNING. Rasterise each ink plate and measure the maximum inscribed width of every pairwise overlap. A trap band is thin; a solid overlap means one ink is sitting under another unexpectedly - usually misregistration within a single artboard, which ARTWORK_IN_REGISTER cannot see.
Check type	numeric_range
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE
Target / measurement definition	<pre>{ "object": "ink_plates", "op": "pairwise_overlap", "measure": "max_inscribed_width_pt" }</pre>
Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "max": 2 }</pre>
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	detects 22875 planted defect (Brown 2.40pt vs blues). Good files: 22834 max 1.07pt, 91825 max 1.36pt at 0.0% area. Threshold 2.0pt separates on 9 files - NOT well calibrated, needs more corpus
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	100
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 17 OF 38 · NOT BUILT

Swatch label block matches the artwork

SWATCH_LABEL_MANIFEST

Rules view fields

Status	Not Built
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	The swatch label block on the file does not match the artwork. Check which list is right before releasing - the label is what the press operator reads.

Full stored rule details

Description	Pre-Press Pro writes the swatch list as LIVE text on the Reg Marks & Info layer. That block is a machine-readable manifest of intended inks. Extract it and cross-check against (a) the separations declared in /ColorSpace and (b) the separations actually painted. Three independent views of the same list.
Check type	enum_match
Layer scope	Reg Marks & Info
Target / measurement definition	`{ "object": "label_text", "parse": "swatch_names", "compare": [ "declared", "painted" ] }`
Expected values / rule definition	`{ "all_three_agree": true }`
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	22554: label lists 5 inks including 5-230-Gold 110 C; /ColorSpace declares all 5; only 4 are painted. Text extraction verified working via ToUnicode maps
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	101
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 18 OF 38 · NOT BUILT

Ink change noted for production

INK_CHANGE_DECLARED

Rules view fields

Status	Not Built
Severity	info
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	This job includes an ink change on one head - the press will stop, clean and reload mid-run. Make sure production scheduling accounts for it.

Full stored rule details

Description	A swatch with ONE head group and TWO ink names signals an ink change mid-run: the press stops, one ink is cleaned out and the other loaded. Not a defect - surface it so scheduling and the press know.
Check type	regex_match
Layer scope	*
Target / measurement definition	<pre>{ "object": "colorants", "field": "name" }</pre>
Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "pattern": "^\\d+(?:-\\d+)?-[^&]+&[^&]+$", "meaning": "ink_change" }</pre>
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	22699 "5-200-Grey 429 & Yellow 121" - confirmed by Tyler as an ink change
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	102
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 19 OF 38 · ENABLED

Stray sub-spec strokes look like trim residue

TRIM_ARTIFACT_RESIDUE

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	`min_pt: 0.25` `min_count: 3`
Remediation	Stray zero-ink strokes below trap spec - most likely residue from an Illustrator trim. Usually harmless, but check whether removing them changes the look before releasing.

Full stored rule details

Description	Zero-ink strokes well under the 0.75pt trap spec, on a job with no trapping need, are usually residue left by an Illustrator trim operation. Often harmless, occasionally left deliberately because removing them changes the look. A judgement call, never an automatic reject.
Check type	numeric_range
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE

Target / measurement definition	<pre>{
	  "object": "strokes",
	  "filter": {
	  "zero_ink": true
	  },
	  "field": "width_pt"
	}</pre>

Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "min_pt": 0.25, "min_count": 3 }</pre>
Tolerance	<pre>{ "abs": 0.02, "unit": "pt" }</pre>
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	18496: 14 zero-ink strokes at 0.25pt on a white-only job - confirmed as trim residue
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	103
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 20 OF 38 · ENABLED

Gradient blend technique present

GRADIENT_BLEND_ACROSS_ARTBOARDS

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	Gradient blending across artboards is a deliberate technique for a smooth transition. Not a fault - confirm layering with the press operator and do not auto-release.

Full stored rule details

Description	Gradients painted with sh shading operators, where artboards carry different inks that blend at the seam. One colour is deliberately run further beneath the other so the transition is smooth without needing impeccable registration. A recognised technique - surface it, do not fail it.
Check type	boolean_presence
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE
Target / measurement definition	<pre>{ "object": "shadings", "field": "present" }</pre>
Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "value": true }</pre>
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	22617: 23 sh ops per artboard, Separation-based shadings in Yellow 108/White (AB0) and Orange 158/Blue 7688/Cool Gray 11 (AB1) - confirmed as a deliberate blend technique
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	104
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 21 OF 38 · ENABLED

Base exists under every colour that needs one

UNDERBASE_COVERAGE

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	`partial_below_pct: 15` `partial_above_pct: 85`
Remediation	The number of underbase shapes does not match the number of colour shapes needing a base. Something was missed - send back to seps.io with the shape count.

Full stored rule details

Description	Counts colour shapes requiring a base against base copies found.
Check type	count_match
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE

Target / measurement definition	`{`
	`  "object": "choke_pairs"`
	`}`

Expected values / rule definition	`{`
	`  "partial_below_pct": 15,`
	`  "partial_above_pct": 85,`
	`  "note": "an ink between these two is only partly based, which prints two shades"`
	`}`

Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	true
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	11/11, 7/7
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	110
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 22 OF 38 · NOT BUILT

Underbase present on dark garments

UNDERBASE_REQUIRED_DARK

Rules view fields

Status	Not Built
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	This is a dark garment with no underbase separation. Send back to seps.io - the colours will not opacity up without one.

Full stored rule details

Description	Dark garment jobs need a base under every non-black ink. Black prints direct.
Check type	boolean_presence
Layer scope	*

Target / measurement definition	<pre>{
	  "object": "colorants",
	  "filter": {
	  "role": "underbase"
	  }
	}</pre>

Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "value": true }</pre>
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	<pre>{ "garment_shade": "dark", "top_ink_role_not": "black" }</pre>
Requires context	true
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	confirmed by Tyler: black on dark takes no base
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	120
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 23 OF 38 · NOT BUILT

No underbase on light garments

UNDERBASE_ABSENT_LIGHT

Rules view fields

Status	Not Built
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	An underbase is present on a light garment. Confirm with the artist - if it is not needed, ask seps.io to remove it and save a screen.

Full stored rule details

Description	A base on a white garment is a wasted screen.
Check type	boolean_presence
Layer scope	*

Target / measurement definition	{
	"object": "colorants",
	"filter": {
	"role": "underbase"
	}
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	"value": false
	}

Tolerance	{}

Applies when	{
	"garment_shade": "light"
	}

Requires context	true
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	untested - no light-garment sample
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	130
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 24 OF 38 · ENABLED

Every art object uses a spot separation

SEPARATION_ONLY_ART

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	An object is painted in a colour space that is not one of our spot separations - it will not separate to a plate. Ask seps.io to convert it to the correct named spot swatch, or remove it.

Full stored rule details

Description	Generalises the old RGB check. Every painted object on the art layer must use a /Separation (or /DeviceN of separations). ICCBased, DeviceCMYK, DeviceRGB and DeviceGray fills are unconverted art and will not separate - the zero-ink knockout fill is the only legitimate exception.
Check type	boolean_presence
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE

Target / measurement definition	{
	  "object": "objects",
	  "field": "colorspace_family"
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	  "in": [
	  "Separation",
	  "DeviceN"
	  ],
	  "except": {
	  "DeviceCMYK": [
	  0,
	  0,
	  0,
	  0
	  ]
	  }
	}

Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	caught 22829 planted defect: ICCBased N=4 fill at C0.024 M0.663 Y0.690 K0 (orange)
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	140
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 25 OF 38 · ENABLED

No stray CMYK plates

NO_PROCESS_PLATES

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	Process (CMYK) plates carry ink in a spot-colour job. Ask seps.io whether this is intentional simulated process or a conversion that was missed.

Full stored rule details

Description	Process plates in a spot job usually mean an unconverted object.
Check type	boolean_presence
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE

Target / measurement definition	<pre>{
	  "object": "colorants",
	  "filter": {
	  "type": "process",
	  "ink_coverage_gt": 0
	  }
	}</pre>

Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "value": false }</pre>
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	<pre>{ "print_method": "screenprint" }</pre>
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	4/4 pass
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	150
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 26 OF 38 · ENABLED

Every declared separation carries artwork

NO_EMPTY_PLATES

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	A separation is declared in the swatches but has no artwork on any artboard. Either a colour was dropped from the design and left in the swatch list, or artwork is missing. Confirm the intended colour count with the order before burning screens.

Full stored rule details

Description	Compare the separations DECLARED in /ColorSpace against the separations actually painted (fills, strokes AND sh shadings). A declared colorant with no marks is a screen burned for nothing, and usually means a colour was dropped from the art but left in the swatch list.
Check type	coverage_threshold
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE

Target / measurement definition	{
	  "object": "colorants",
	  "compare": [
	  "declared",
	  "painted"
	  ],
	  "exclude": [
	  "All"
	  ]
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	  "declared_equals_painted": true
	}

Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	caught 22554 planted defect: 5-230-Gold 110 C declared and labelled, zero marks
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	160
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 27 OF 38 · ENABLED

All artwork text outlined

ART_TEXT_OUTLINED

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	Live text is sitting on the artwork. Ask seps.io to outline it - type reflows on a machine without the font. Text in the margin strip is the filename and swatch labels and is expected to stay live.

Full stored rule details

Description	Live text must be outlined. Neither the layer nor the ink discriminates the info block from artwork: art legitimately sits on the Reg Marks layer, and the swatch labels are painted in each ink. POSITION does - Pre-Press Pro sets the filename and label block in the margin strip above the artwork, so a text run whose origin falls inside the art bounding box is artwork text wherever it lives.
Check type	geometry
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE
Target / measurement definition	<pre>{ "object": "text_runs", "field": "origin", "test": "inside_art_bbox" }</pre>
Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "runs_inside_art_bbox": 0 }</pre>
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	55 files: exactly 1 run in 1 file (22560 B) lands inside the art. Two earlier versions of this rule were withdrawn - filtering by layer fired on every file whose art sits on the marks layer, and filtering by ink fired on the swatch labels, which are painted in their own ink by design
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	170
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 28 OF 38 · ENABLED

Marks layer text is expected

MARKS_TEXT_EXPECTED

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	info
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	No file info or swatch labels found on the marks layer. The file may not have been run through Pre-Press Pro - confirm before release.

Full stored rule details

Description	Informational. Live text on Reg Marks & Info is the script's own output, not a defect.
Check type	boolean_presence
Layer scope	Reg Marks & Info
Target / measurement definition	<pre>{ "object": "text", "field": "is_live" }</pre>
Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "value": true }</pre>
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	4/4 have 2-8 live text ops
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	180
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 29 OF 38 · NOT BUILT

Placed images at least 300 dpi

IMAGE_MIN_DPI

Rules view fields

Status	Not Built
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	A placed image is below 300 dpi at its placed size. Check the plate preview - if the halftone looks soft, request higher-resolution art from the customer.

Full stored rule details

Description	Effective resolution at placed size.
Check type	numeric_range
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE

Target / measurement definition	{
	  "object": "images",
	  "field": "effective_dpi"
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	  "min": 300
	}

Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	UNTESTED - no sample has a raster
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	190
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 30 OF 38 · NOT BUILT

Placed images above hard floor

IMAGE_HARD_MIN_DPI

Rules view fields

Status	Not Built
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	A placed image is below 200 dpi at placed size and will visibly pixelate. Request higher-resolution source art before this goes to the floor.

Full stored rule details

Description	Below 200 dpi is not printable at any size we run.
Check type	numeric_range
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE

Target / measurement definition	{
	  "object": "images",
	  "field": "effective_dpi"
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	  "min": 200
	}

Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	UNTESTED - no sample has a raster
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	200
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 31 OF 38 · NOT BUILT

Placed images not RGB

IMAGE_NOT_RGB

Rules view fields

Status	Not Built
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	A placed image is still in RGB. Ask seps.io to convert it into the separation.

Full stored rule details

Description	Checked specifically on rasters.
Check type	enum_match
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE
Target / measurement definition	<pre>{ "object": "images", "field": "colorspace" }</pre>
Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "not_in": ["DeviceRGB", "CalRGB"] }</pre>
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	UNTESTED - no sample has a raster
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	210
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 32 OF 38 · ENABLED

No zero-width strokes

NO_HAIRLINE_STROKES

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	Zero-width (hairline) strokes found. Ask seps.io to set a real stroke weight - hairlines drop out or print inconsistently.

Full stored rule details

Description	A 0pt stroke will not hold on press.
Check type	numeric_range
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE
Target / measurement definition	<pre>{ "object": "strokes", "field": "effective_pt", "exclude": "choke" }</pre>
Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "max_zero_width": 0 }</pre>
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	4/4 pass
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	220
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 33 OF 38 · ENABLED

Minimum stroke weight

STROKE_MIN_WIDTH

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	`min_pt: 0.25`
Remediation	Strokes thinner than 0.25pt found. These may not hold on press. Confirm with the artist or ask seps.io to thicken.

Full stored rule details

Description	Below the minimum will not hold at our mesh counts.
Check type	numeric_range
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE
Target / measurement definition	<pre>{ "object": "strokes", "field": "effective_pt", "exclude": "choke" }</pre>
Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "min_pt": 0.25 }</pre>
Tolerance	<pre>{ "abs": 0.02, "unit": "pt" }</pre>
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	4/4 pass
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	230
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 34 OF 38 · NOT BUILT

Plate count matches ordered colours

PLATE_COUNT_MATCHES_ORDER

Rules view fields

Status	Not Built
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	The separation count does not match the colour count on the order. Either the order is wrong or seps.io added or merged a colour - resolve before screens are burned, this is a costing issue.

Full stored rule details

Description	Unique colorants across ALL artboards, minus 'All'.
Check type	count_match
Layer scope	*

Target / measurement definition	{
	  "object": "colorants",
	  "scope": "all_artboards",
	  "exclude": [
	  "All"
	  ]
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	  "source": "job_context",
	  "field": "ink_count"
	}

Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	true
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	4/4 match stated colour counts
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	240
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 35 OF 38 · ENABLED

Artboards share trim size and origin

ARTBOARDS_REGISTERED

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	The artboards in this file are not the same size or origin. Ask seps.io to resave with matching artboards - as delivered the separations cannot be overlaid.

Full stored rule details

Description	Geometry check only — artboards must be the same size and origin so plates overlay. This does NOT verify that the artwork aligns; see ARTWORK_IN_REGISTER.
Check type	dimension_match
Layer scope	*
Target / measurement definition	<pre>{ "object": "artboards", "field": "trimbox" }</pre>
Expected values / rule definition	<pre>{ "all_equal": true }</pre>
Tolerance	<pre>{ "abs": 0.01, "unit": "in" }</pre>
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	2/2 multi-artboard files pass
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	250
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 36 OF 38 · NOT BUILT

Print size within location preset

PRINT_SIZE_VS_LOCATION

Rules view fields

Status	Not Built
Severity	fail
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	Artwork is larger than our preset maximum for this print location. Check against the approved proof - either the proof was approved at this size, or seps.io scaled it.

Full stored rule details

Description	Artwork bounds on the art layer against the location preset max.
Check type	dimension_match
Layer scope	PASTE ART HERE

Target / measurement definition	{
	"object": "geometry",
	"field": "art_bbox_in"
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	"source": "location_presets",
	"field": "max_in"
	}

Tolerance	{
	"abs": 0.125,
	"unit": "in"
	}

Applies when	{}
Requires context	true
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	untested - needs presets loaded
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	260
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 37 OF 38 · ENABLED

Opacity below 100% present

OPACITY_VARIATION_PRESENT

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	flag
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	This file uses opacity below 100%, which halftones at RIP. Intentional special handling - confirm layering with the press operator; do not auto-release.

Full stored rule details

Description	Any fill or group below 100% opacity is converted to halftones by the RIP when the plate is output. This is a deliberate technique, not a fault - like gradient blending, it signals a file that needs precise layering at press. Report it so the press operator knows, and route it out of any automated generator.
Check type	boolean_presence
Layer scope	*

Target / measurement definition	{
	  "object": "ext_gstate",
	  "fields": [
	  "ca",
	  "CA"
	  ],
	  "recurse_forms": true
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{
	  "value": false
	}

Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	1 of 24 files. 22541 B REVISED carries six alpha values (0.2, 0.25, 0.37, 0.4, 0.45, 0.5) plus one soft mask; the other 23 files have none. No blend modes anywhere in the corpus - alpha alone is the signal
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	101
Stored enabled value	true

RULE 38 OF 38 · ENABLED

Mesh tally for the screen department

MESH_TALLY

Rules view fields

Status	Enabled
Severity	info
Thresholds shown in view	–
Remediation	—

Full stored rule details

Description	Counts screens per mesh from the swatch names. Not a pass/fail check - this is the forecast input the screen room needs (e.g. 160mesh-2, 230mesh-3).
Check type	tally
Layer scope	*

Target / measurement definition	{
	  "object": "colorants",
	  "field": "mesh"
	}

Expected values / rule definition	{}
Tolerance	{}
Applies when	{}
Requires context	false
Validation notes (stored, not independently revalidated)	parses 16/17 historical names; '1-110 Under' uses a space delimiter and is handled
Illustrator action	–
Sort order	45
Stored enabled value	true

Consultant review worksheet

The prompts below are suggestions for defining each Not Built rule, not approved policy or changes to SepScope.

- What exact condition should pass, flag, or fail? Define units, tolerances and boundary cases.
- What evidence comes from the artwork, the order, garment data or operator input?
- When should the rule not apply? What should happen when required information is unavailable?
- What legitimate techniques or exceptions must not be treated as defects?
- Which known-good and intentionally defective samples should validate the rule?
- What should the reviewer or separation artist do when the rule triggers?

No rule settings or implementation were changed for this export.